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Accelerating transformation towards Climate-Smart Agriculture in Kenya 40 Kenyan cases studies to guide decision making

10 October 2014 - **The Kenya National Climate Change and Agriculture Workshop** held in Nairobi from 8–9 October gathered **quantifiable evidence** and **summarized knowledge gaps and recommendations** that could **accelerate the adoption of climate-smart agriculture approach in Kenya**.

Organized by the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations in partnership with the Climate Change Unit of the Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock and Fisheries, the World Agroforestry Centre (ICRAF) and the Climate Change, Agriculture and Food Security Research Programme (CCAFS), the meeting gathered key decision makers and experts from development organizations, government, academia and civil society who discussed the current state of knowledge on what climate-smart agriculture is and its relevance to national agricultural and environmental policies.

In his opening statement, the Deputy Director of the Climate Change Secretariat during his opening statement Mr. Moses Omedi said, "The Government's **goodwill** to address climate change is **very high**. Multiple stakeholders have been engaged in the process of developing a climate change response strategy for Kenya. Both adaptation and mitigation are important, although the **short term priority is adaptation**. Nevertheless, addressing the root cause of the problem requires reductions of greenhouse gas emissions produced by agriculture."

During the workshop, 40 projects were discussed. These projects focused on climate-smart approaches for agricultural systems with livestock, aquaculture, bioenergy, agroforestry, conservation agriculture, various cropping systems and related climate information and insurance, as well as their adoption, capacity development and gender mainstreaming.

One example of field experiments and farmer evidence was the pilot project coordinated by FAO Mitigation of Climate Change in Agriculture Programme within the framework of the East Africa Dairy Development Project (EADD). Since 2011, this pilot project has **improved livelihoods of over 4 900 farmers** and **reduced the carbon footprint of dairy products in Kenya**.

The participants concluded that climate-smart agriculture needs integration at different levels, including looking at farms as entities as well as linking research, development and policy making closely together. The participants also emphasized that climate-smart interventions need to be context-specific and sensitive to cultural norms. More research is required to fill the many knowledge gaps that still exist. "We hoped that this workshop would help in gathering the vast experience of putting the climate-smart approach into practice in Kenya. Many researchers, policy-makers, practitioners and farmers have worked hard to gather evidence and find best practices for several years" said Ms. Kaisa Karttunen, Senior Natural Resources Officer working for FAO Mitigation of Climate Change in Agriculture (MICCA) Programme.

The workshop was an opportunity for national experts to provide recommendations that feed into the draft of the National Climate Change Framework Policy realized this year in Kenya. Ms. Janet Oyuke from the Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock and Fisheries told the participants that the Ministry has already established a Climate-Smart Agriculture Task Force that is open for new stakeholders. Currently, the Task Force consists of representatives from the administration, research community and farmers' organizations.

The gathering took place just prior to the celebrations of World Food Day (16 October). The 2014 World Food Day theme *Family Farming: "Feeding the world, caring for the earth"* - focuses world attention on the significant role of family farming in eradicating hunger, poverty and malnutrition and achieving sustainable development.

Since 2011, FAO's Mitigation of Climate Change in Agriculture Programme (MICCA) and the World Agroforestry Centre ICRAF and the East Africa Dairy Development Project have focused in Kaptumo on understanding how climate-smart practices in smallholder farming systems can increase agricultural productivity and incomes; adapt and build resilience to climate change; and reduce and/or remove greenhouse gas emissions.

For more information, please visit: www.fao.org/climatechange/micca/87624

FAO Director-General addresses UN Climate Change Summit

More on Climate-smart agriculture: <http://bit.ly/fao-csa-summary>

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